

20-year career · mentor ask · pay forward

Alumni networks are the single largest lever for opportunity, emotional support, and mid-career reinvention. Most learners underuse them. This lesson shows how to use V-Align's network from Day 1 of graduation.

Which alumni do you already know by name?

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01** Finding + keeping a mentor
- 02** Pay it forward
- 03** Rejections + gaps
- 04** Staying current — 5 cadences
- 05** Alumni-only benefits

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

12 weeks built the skill. The next 20 years are the career.

WHY

Real

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SCALE

Today

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SPEED

Now

A real reason this matters in industry today.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

Use V-Align alumni network.

2

A 30-min / month mentor relationship.

3

Handle rejections + gaps.

4

Pay-forward loops.

5

Staying-current cadence.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

Finding + keeping a mentor

The ask

02

Pay it forward

Key concept of this lesson.

03

Rejections + gaps

Normalise

04

Staying current — 5 cadences

Key concept of this lesson.

01

PART 1 OF 4

Finding + keeping a mentor

The ask

CONCEPT 1 OF 4

Finding + keeping a mentor

Pick someone 5-10 years ahead.

"Would you be my 30-min / month mentor for 6 months?"

Come with an agenda; respect time.

Update on wins they caused.

Graduate gracefully after 6 months.

ASK

30 min × 6 mo

Time-boxed + specific.

DEFINITION

Finding + keeping a mentor

The ask

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Pay it forward

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

Rejections + gaps

Rejection $\neq$ identity.

Gap months: publish more, not less.

Alumni is the fastest re-engagement lane.

One coffee a week keeps the network warm.

TRUTH

Gaps happen

Plan for them.

DEFINITION

Rejections + gaps

Normalise

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Staying current — 5 cadences

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Draft the message

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

1

2

3

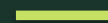
4

Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check



Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

Mentor ask length:

A

Open-ended

B

30 min / month $\times$ 6

C

Daily

D

1 yr

Mentor ask length:

CORRECT ANSWER



30 min / month × 6

WHY

Time-boxed

Pay forward:

A

Only later

B

Start now

C

Never

D

Secretly

Pay forward:



CORRECT ANSWER

Start now

WHY

Now, while fresh

Gap-month rule:

A

Hide

B

Publish more

C

Do nothing

D

Panic

Gap-month rule:



CORRECT ANSWER

Publish more

WHY

Visibility survives gaps

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

First ask

Message a mentor and an alumni today.

DELIVERABLES

- Pick names.
- Draft messages.
- Send; log responses.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

Deliverable: Screenshots on LMS.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

"A 12-week programme, a 20-year home."

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 12

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

NEXT → Projects & Final Assessment.